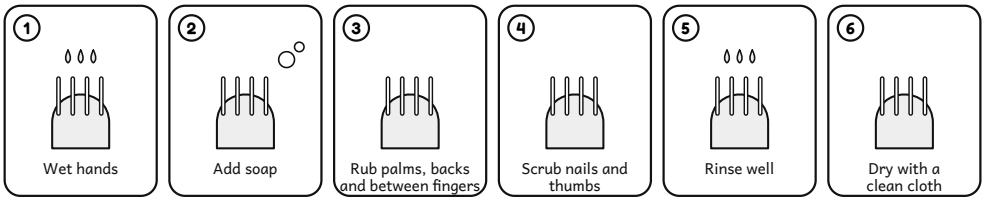
LIVING THINGS

Staying Healthy

A healthy lifestyle, germs and disease, hygiene and prevention



In this pack

Learn it: Staying healthy and stopping disease ★☆☆
Fact check: Healthy habits and germs ★☆☆
Think it through: Causes, risks and choices ★★☆
Investigate: How well do we wash our hands? ★★☆
Real-world case study: Dengue: a city fights a mosquito ★★★
Review and challenge: Show what you know ★★★

This pack belongs to: _____ **Class:** _____

© InquiryMind · Learn · Play · Wonder · Free resources for everyone, bringing quality and equity to education and helping teachers build concepts and make learning visible · Illustrations drawn for InquiryMind · Print in black and white on A4 · Challenge: ★ core ★★ deeper ★★★ stretch

Staying healthy and stopping disease

Name: Class: Date:

Learning goals

- Identify what we need for a healthy lifestyle.
- Explain how germs cause and spread diseases.
- Describe habits and choices that prevent disease.

Being healthy means your body and mind work well. Doctors say that to stay healthy we need **clean surroundings, clean air and safe water, good personal hygiene, nutritious food, exercise and enough sleep**. When these needs are not met, people are more likely to become ill.

Six things a healthy body needs

- **Clean surroundings:** rubbish and dirty water attract flies, rats and mosquitoes that spread germs.
- **Clean air and safe water:** dirty water can carry germs that cause diarrhoea, cholera and typhoid.
- **Hygiene:** washing hands with soap, brushing teeth and bathing remove germs.
- **Nutritious food:** a balanced diet helps the body grow and fight infection.
- **Exercise:** keeps the heart, lungs, muscles and bones strong. Children need about one hour of activity a day.
- **Sleep:** children aged 6 to 12 need about 9 to 12 hours of sleep to grow, learn and stay well.

What are germs?

Germs (microbes) are living things so small that we need a microscope to see them. Most are harmless, and some are even useful, but some cause **disease**. Germs include **bacteria**, **viruses**, **fungi** and **parasites**.

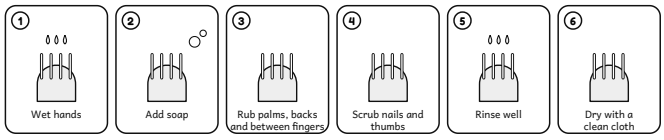
How do diseases spread?

Way germs spread	Examples of diseases
dirty water and food	diarrhoea, cholera, typhoid
coughs and sneezes (air)	flu, colds, tuberculosis
insect bites	dengue and malaria (mosquitoes)
touching people or dirty surfaces	skin infections, eye infections

Diseases that spread from person to person are **infectious**. Others, such as diabetes and heart disease, do not spread. They are linked to **lifestyle**: for example, too little exercise or too much sugar and fat.

How can we prevent disease?

- Wash hands with soap for **20 seconds**, especially before eating and after using the toilet.
- Drink safe water: boiled, filtered or from a safe tube-well.
- Use a clean toilet (latrine).
- Cover coughs and sneezes with a tissue or your elbow.
- Get **vaccinated**: vaccines train the body to fight a germ before it attacks.
- Stop mosquitoes breeding: empty containers of standing water at least once a week.



Six steps for washing your hands properly.

Bangladesh connection

In the 1960s and 1970s, scientists at the cholera research hospital in Dhaka (today called **icddr,b**) helped show that a simple drink of clean water, salt and sugar could save people with severe diarrhoea. This **oral rehydration solution (ORS)** has since saved millions of lives around the world.

Did you know?

Bangladesh's vaccination programme reaches the great majority of children, protecting them from diseases such as measles, polio and tetanus.

Key words

hygiene	keeping clean to stay healthy
germ	tiny living thing that can cause disease
infectious disease	a disease that spreads from person to person
vaccine	medicine that trains the body to fight a germ
symptom	a sign of illness, such as fever or cough
ORS	oral rehydration solution: water, salts and sugar
risk factor	something that makes a disease more likely

InquiryMind
LEARN · PLAY · WONDER

FACT CHECK · A3 · STAYING HEALTHY

Healthy habits and germs

★☆☆
Grade 5

Name: Class: Date:

Learning goals

- Recall what we need to stay healthy.
- Link diseases to how they spread.

1 Fill in the gaps. [6]

WORD BANK

vaccine hygiene television exercise sugar sleep germs water

To stay healthy we need clean air and safe _____, good _____, nutritious food, _____ and enough _____. Tiny living things that cause disease are called _____. A _____ trains the body to fight a germ.

2 Sort the diseases by how they spread. [4]

SORT THESE

dengue flu typhoid cholera malaria diarrhoea common cold tuberculosis

Dirty water or food	Air (coughs, sneezes)	Mosquito bites

3 True or false? [5]

Statement	True	False	If false, correct it
1. All germs cause disease.			
2. Washing hands with soap for 20 seconds removes most germs.			
3. Diabetes spreads from person to person.			
4. Children aged 10 need about 9 to 12 hours of sleep.			
5. Mosquitoes breed in standing water.			

4 **Put the handwashing steps in order.** [3]

- [ ] Dry with a clean cloth.
- [ ] Add soap.
- [ ] Wet your hands with clean water.
- [ ] Rinse well.
- [ ] Rub palms, backs of hands and between fingers.
- [ ] Scrub nails and thumbs.

Causes, risks and choices

★★☆
Grade 5

Name: Class: Date:

Learning goals

- Link unhealthy conditions to diseases.
- Suggest behaviours that prevent disease.

1 **For each problem, name a disease it could cause and a way to prevent it.** [8]

Problem	Possible disease	How to prevent it
drinking pond water		
flower tubs full of old rainwater		
eating without washing hands		
sitting with screens all day, eating crisps and sweets		

2 **Explain why a vaccine protects not only you but also other people.** [2]

3 **A child has diarrhoea and is losing a lot of water. Why is ORS more helpful than plain water?** [2]

4 **Rafi says, "I slept for 5 hours, but I'm fine." Explain why sleep matters for children.** [2]

INVESTIGATE · A3 · STAYING HEALTHY

How well do we wash our hands?

★★☆ Grade 5

Name: Class: Date:

Learning goals

- Plan a fair test using a model of germs.
- Present results in a bar chart.
- Draw a conclusion and evaluate the method.

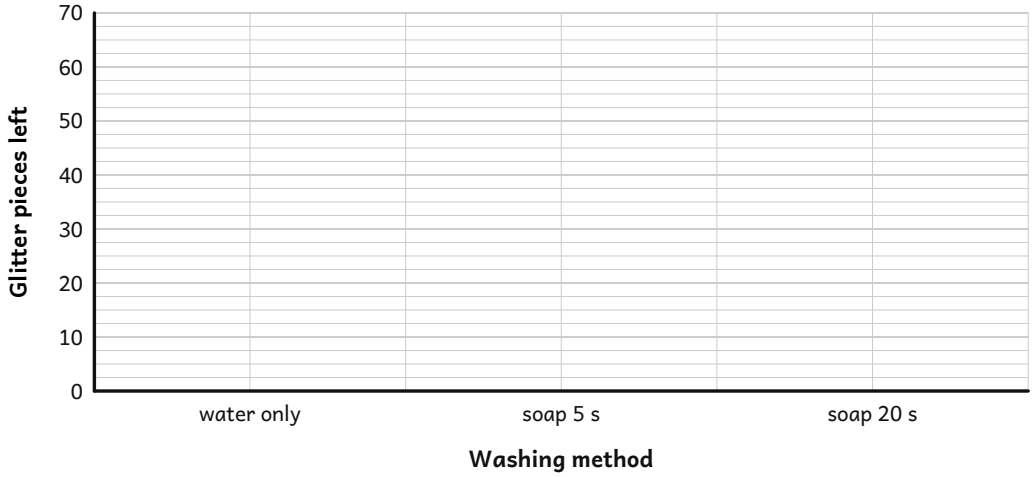
Germs are too small to see, so Class 5C used a **model**: they rubbed a teaspoon of cooking oil mixed with glitter onto their hands. The glitter stood for germs. Then they washed in different ways and counted the glitter pieces left on one hand.

1 **Name the variables.** [3]

What we change	
What we measure	
What we keep the same	

2 **Here are the results (average of 3 learners for each method).** [4]

Method	water only	soap, 5 seconds	soap, 20 seconds
Glitter left	64	30	6



3 **Write a conclusion.** [2]

.....

.....

4 **How is the glitter model like real germs, and how is it different?** [2]

a) Like real germs:

.....

b) Different from real germs:

.....

REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY · A3 · STAYING HEALTHY

Dengue: a city fights a mosquito

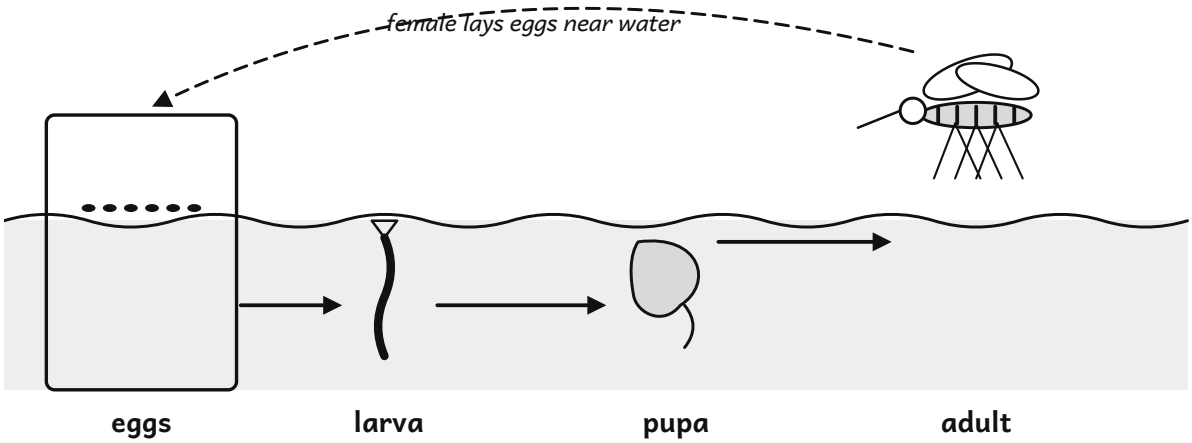
★★★
Grade 5

Name: Class: Date:

Learning goals

- Explain how a disease spreads using a life cycle.
- Interpret data about cases over the year.
- Argue for actions that reduce risk.

Science | Health | Maths | Geography | Citizenship



Life cycle of the Aedes mosquito. From egg to adult takes about 7 to 10 days in warm weather.

Dengue is a disease caused by a virus. It is spread by the bite of the female **Aedes** mosquito, which has black and white stripes and often bites in the daytime. Symptoms include a high fever, headache and pain in the muscles and joints. Most people recover with rest and fluids, but some become seriously ill and need hospital care.

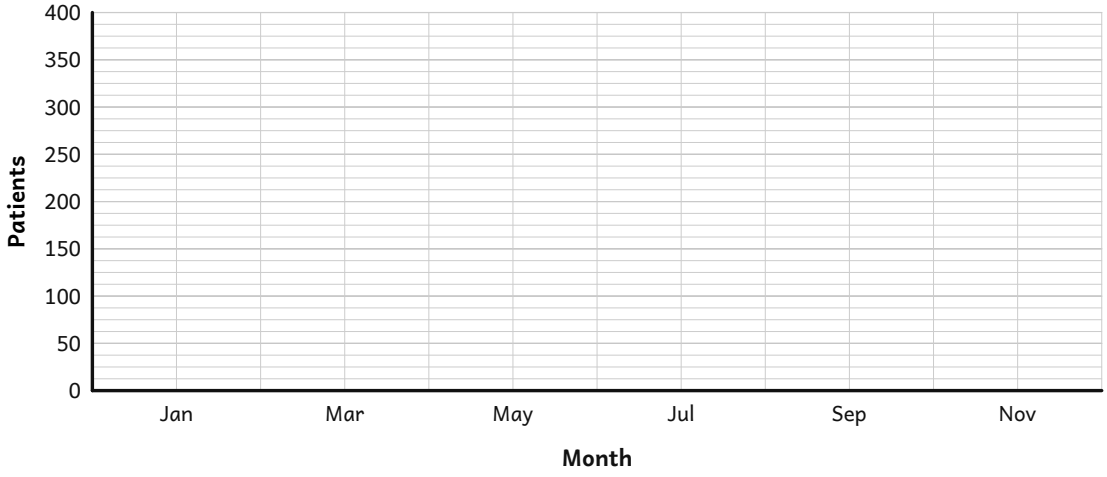
Aedes mosquitoes lay their eggs in small amounts of **clean, still water**: flower tubs, old tyres, plastic containers, rooftop gardens and building sites. The eggs can survive dry for months and hatch when it rains.

Dengue cases in Bangladesh rise during and after the monsoon. **2023 was the worst dengue year on record in the country.** City corporations spray to kill mosquitoes and run "clean-up" campaigns, but experts say every household must help by removing breeding places.

Information: Directorate General of Health Services (DGHS) and WHO dengue fact sheets.

1 **Use the life cycle to explain why emptying water containers every week stops mosquitoes.** [2]

2 **This chart shows example numbers of dengue patients in one city hospital each month.** [5]



Month	Jan	Mar	May	Jul	Sep	Nov
Patients	10	15	40	260	380	150

a) Draw the bars on the chart.

b) In which months are there most cases? Suggest why.

.....

.....

c) How many more patients were there in September than in May?

.....

3 **Who is responsible for stopping dengue? Give one job for each.** [3]

Who	What they can do
each family	
schools	
the city	

4 **Design a short poster message (no more than 12 words) to persuade your neighbours to act.** [2]

Your message

Show what you know

★★★
Grade 5

Name: Class: Date:

Learning goals

- Use key vocabulary.
- Answer test-style questions.

1 **Find the key words.**

K	D	E	N	G	U	E	J	K	T	M
P	V	E	X	E	R	C	I	S	E	V
K	G	D	H	J	F	S	U	S	W	J
C	F	S	W	Y	G	A	U	L	V	G
S	Y	L	D	A	G	W	M	J	I	E
O	J	E	V	G	T	I	D	O	R	R
A	G	E	K	O	M	E	E	B	U	M
P	S	P	Y	D	I	D	R	N	S	V
D	G	G	K	F	Y	E	P	B	E	P
U	R	I	L	U	P	V	T	B	D	P
V	A	C	C	I	N	E	E	U	Y	P

dengue **exercise** **germ** **hygiene** **sleep** **soap** **vaccine** **virus** **water**

2 **Which disease is spread by mosquitoes?** [1]

- ◯ cholera
- ◯ dengue
- ◯ flu
- ◯ typhoid

3 **Which is the best way to make pond water safer to drink?** [1]

- ◯ let it stand for an hour
- ◯ boil it
- ◯ add sugar
- ◯ put it in the fridge

4 **Choose one disease you learned about. Write its cause, one risk factor and how to prevent it.** [4]

Disease	
Cause	
Risk factor	
Prevention	

5 **Challenge. Explain why a city with good drains, clean water and toilets has fewer cases of diarrhoea.** [2]

.....

.....

.....

How am I doing? Colour or tick a circle.

I can...	Not yet	Nearly	Got it!
list six conditions for a healthy lifestyle	○	○	○
explain how germs spread disease	○	○	○
wash my hands properly and explain why	○	○	○
link diseases to their causes and risk factors	○	○	○
explain how to stop mosquitoes spreading dengue	○	○	○
use a model and say how it is like and unlike the real thing	○	○	○